

WHEN SOMEONE I LOVE DIES

A Grief Workbook for Children Ages 5-10

**It's okay to feel sad.
It's okay to feel confused.
It's okay to feel everything.**

By Daniel Tesfamariam

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A MESSAGE TO GROWN-UPS

Dear Parent, Guardian, or Caregiver,

This workbook is designed to help your child process grief in age-appropriate ways. Children grieve differently than adults. They may seem fine one moment and fall apart the next.

HOW TO USE THIS BOOK:

- Go at your child's pace. Don't rush through it.
- Be present. Sit with them and answer questions honestly.
- It's okay to say 'I don't know' or 'I'm sad too.'
- Some pages may be too hard right now. That's okay. Skip them.
- Return to pages as many times as needed.
- Read body language. Stop if they seem overwhelmed.

THINGS CHILDREN NEED TO HEAR:

- 'This is not your fault.'
- 'It's okay to cry. It's also okay not to cry.'
- 'I'm here. I'm not going anywhere.'
- 'There is no wrong way to feel.'
- 'We will get through this together.'

If your child shows prolonged distress, please consider a grief counselor who specializes in children.

WHAT HAPPENED

Someone I love has died.

Their name is: _____

They were my: _____

(grandma, grandpa, mom, dad, sister, brother, friend, pet)

They died on: _____

When I found out, I felt:

sad scared angry confused numb

It's okay to feel ALL of those things.

Dead means their body stopped working.

It is not sleeping. They cannot wake up.

It is not anyone's fault.

Even though they died, my love for them
will NEVER die. Love lasts forever.

FEELINGS ARE OKAY

Circle how you feel today (you can circle more than one!):

☐

~~SAD~~RY

☐☐

~~SAD~~RED

☐☐

~~L~~APPY

☐☐

~~W~~ORRIED

☐☐

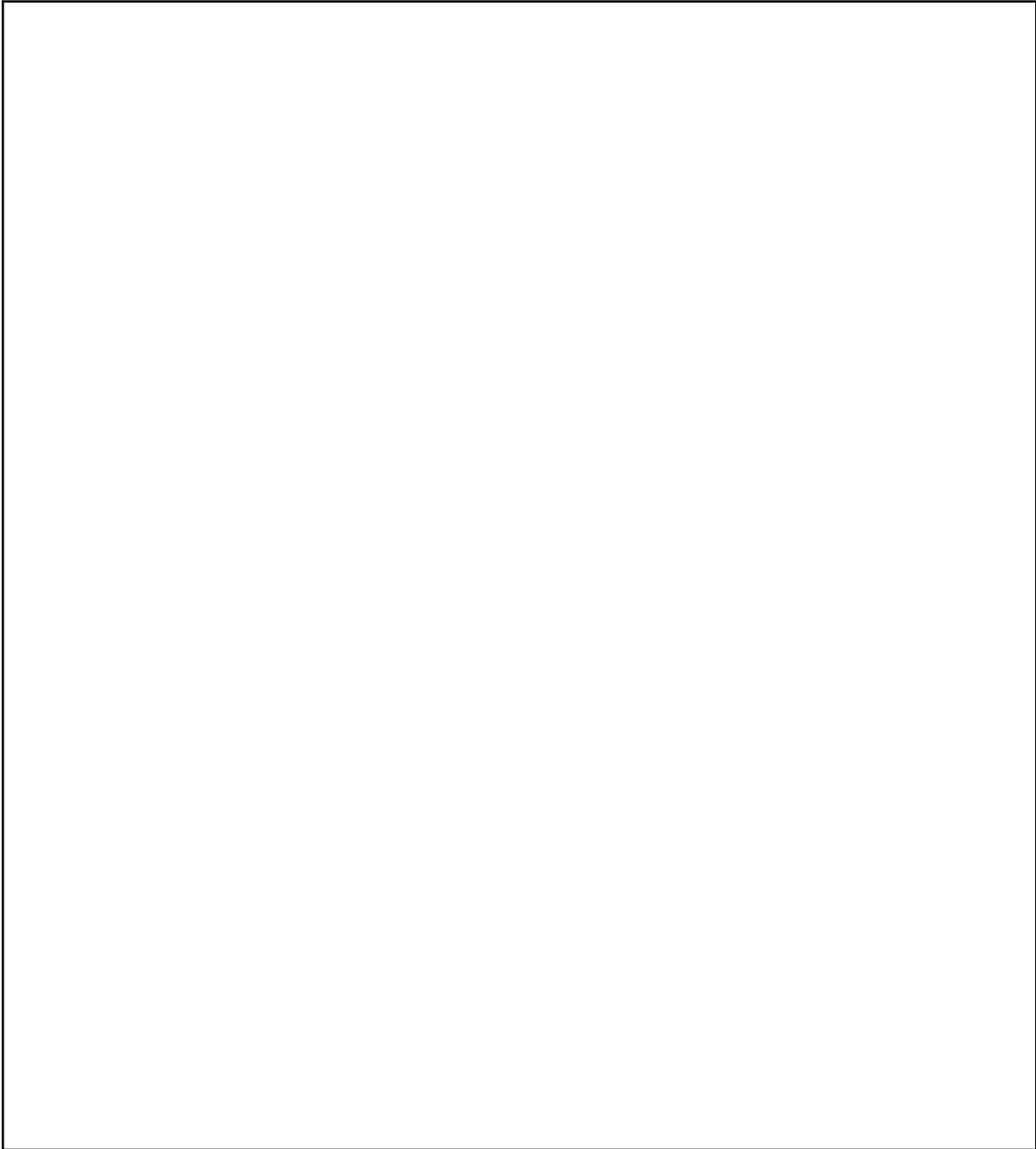
~~N~~ERVOUS

☐

MY PERSON

Draw a picture of the person who died.

What did they look like? What do you remember about them?



Their name: _____

THINGS I REMEMBER

Write or draw things you remember about your person:

Their favorite food was: _____

They always used to say: _____

They smelled like: _____

Their laugh sounded like: _____

Something funny they did: _____

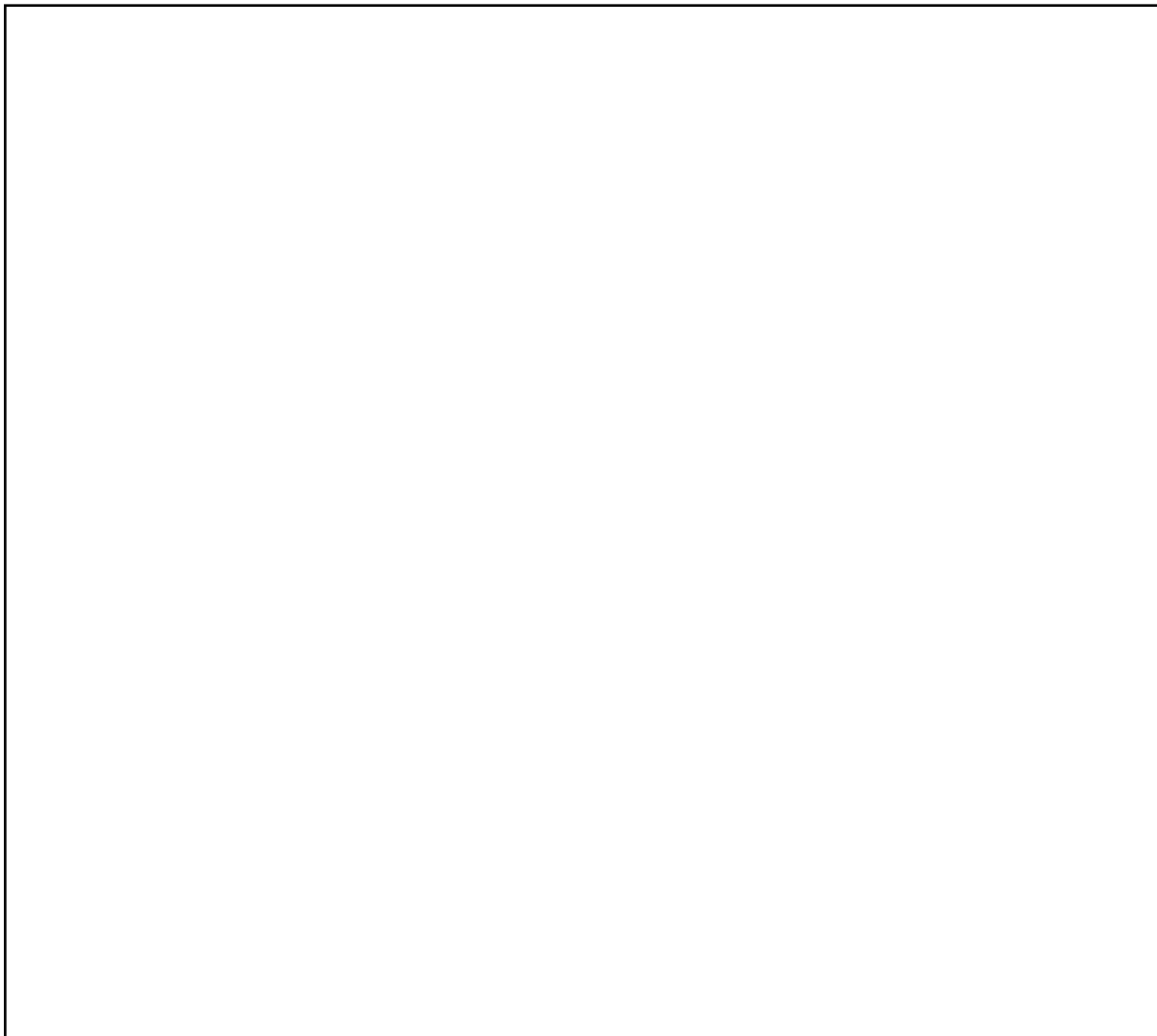
They made me feel: _____

The best thing about them was: _____

I will never forget: _____

OUR SPECIAL TIMES

Draw or write about a happy time you had together:



What we were doing: _____

How I felt: _____

WHO HELPS ME FEEL BETTER

When I feel sad, these people help me:

Person 1: _____

How they help: _____

Person 2: _____

How they help: _____

Person 3: _____

How they help: _____

Person 4: _____

How they help: _____

Person 5: _____

How they help: _____

I am NOT alone. People love me.

THINGS THAT MAKE ME FEEL SAFE

When I feel scared or sad, these things help:

My favorite stuffed animal: _____

A blanket or comfy thing: _____

A song that makes me feel better: _____

A place that feels safe: _____

Something I can hold in my hand: _____

A happy memory I can think about: _____

Taking deep breaths helps. Let's try:

Breathe in like you're smelling a flower... 1, 2, 3, 4

Breathe out like you're blowing out candles... 1, 2, 3, 4

IT'S OKAY TO CRY AND LAUGH

Sometimes you might feel happy and then feel guilty about it.

That's normal! Here's what you need to know:

It's OKAY to cry.

Crying means you loved them.

It's OKAY to laugh.

Laughing doesn't mean you forgot them.

It's OKAY to play and have fun.

Your person would WANT you to be happy.

It's OKAY to feel angry.

You can be mad that they're gone.

It's OKAY to be confused.

Death is hard for EVERYONE to understand.

It's OKAY to feel nothing sometimes.

Your heart might need a break.

Whatever you feel is the RIGHT thing to feel.

There is no wrong way to be sad.

Write a letter to the person who died. Tell them anything:

Dear _____,

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

Love, _____

THINGS I WANT TO SAY

If I could talk to them one more time, I would say:

I love you because: _____

I miss you because: _____

I wish I had told you: _____

Thank you for: _____

My favorite thing you taught me: _____

I promise I will: _____

I want you to know: _____

MY WORRY BOX

Write your worries here to let them go:

Sometimes when someone dies, we worry about other things.

I worry that: _____

I worry that: _____

I worry that: _____

I worry that: _____

Now take a deep breath.

You put your worries in this box.

A grown-up can help carry them for you.

Things I can CONTROL:

Things I CANNOT control (let them go):

GOOD MEMORIES I NEVER WANT TO FORGET

Memory 1:

Memory 2:

Memory 3:

Memory 4:

Memory 5:

PEOPLE WHO LOVE ME

Write the names of people who love and care for you:

You are loved. You are never alone.

MY FEELINGS CALENDAR

Color each day: Blue=sad Green=okay Yellow=happy Red=angry

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5	Day 6
Day 7	Day 8	Day 9	Day 10	Day 11	Day 12
Day 13	Day 14	Day 15	Day 16	Day 17	Day 18
Day 19	Day 20	Day 21	Day 22	Day 23	Day 24
Day 25	Day 26	Day 27	Day 28	Day 29	Day 30

I AM BRAVE BECAUSE...

Going through something this hard takes courage.

I am brave because I keep going even when it hurts.

I am brave because I let myself feel sad.

I am brave because I ask for help.

I am brave because: _____

I am strong because: _____

I am growing because: _____

Something I'm proud of myself for:

GOODBYE FOR NOW

Saying goodbye doesn't mean forgetting.

Your person will always be part of you.

**They live on in your memories,
in the things they taught you,
in the love they gave you,
and in the love you still feel.**

**Grief gets softer over time.
Not smaller, but softer.
Like a heavy backpack that slowly gets lighter.**

**You will smile again. You will laugh again.
And that's exactly what your person wants for you.**

**You are loved.
You are brave.
You are going to be okay.**

With love and hope always.